

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024

International Relations - 5

Important Organisations

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Previous Years' Questions:

1. 'Virus of Conflict is affecting the functioning of the SCO'. In the light of the above statement point out the role of India in mitigating the problems. (2023)
2. 'The expansion and strengthening of NATO and a stronger US-Europe strategic partnership works well for India'. What is your opinion about this statement? Give reasons and examples to support your answer. (2023)
3. 'Sea is an important Component of the Cosmos'. Discuss in the light of the above statement the role of the IMO (International Maritime Organisation) in protecting environment and enhancing maritime safety and security. (2023)
4. Critically examine the aims and objectives of SCO. What importance does it hold for India? (2021)
5. The newly tri-nation partnership AUKUS is aimed at countering China's ambitions in the Indo-Pacific region. Is it going to supersede the existing partnerships in the region? Discuss the strength and impact of AUKUS in the present scenario. (2021)
6. Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (QUAD)' is the transforming itself into a trade bloc from a military alliance, in present times – Discuss. (2020)
7. What are the key areas of reform if the WTO has to survive in the present context of 'Trade War', especially keeping in mind the interest of India? (2018)
8. "The broader aims and objectives of WTO are to manage and promote international trade in the era of globalization. But the Doha round of negotiations seem doomed due to differences between the developed and the developing countries." Discuss in the Indian perspective. (2016)
9. India has recently signed to become founding a New Development Bank (NDB) and also the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB). How will the role of the two Banks be different? Discuss the significance of these two Banks for India. (2014)
10. WTO is an important international institution where decisions taken affect countries in profound manner. What is the mandate of WTO and how binding are their decisions? Critically analyse India's stand on the latest round of talks on Food security. (2014)
11. The World Bank and the IMF, collectively known as the Bretton Woods Institutions, are the two inter-governmental pillars supporting the structure of the world's economic and financial order. Superficially, the World Bank and the IMF exhibit many common characteristics, yet their role, functions and mandate are distinctly different. Elucidate. (2013)

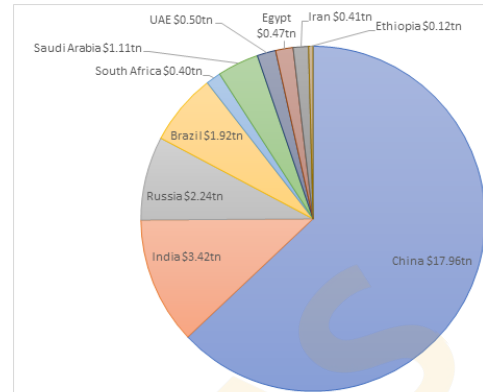
BRICS

BRICS is an acronym coined to associate five major emerging economies: Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa. It is an example of South-south cooperation. At the 15th BRICS summit at Johannesburg, BRICS has invited Iran, the United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, and Ethiopia. They became members from 1st January 2024. This will strengthen BRICS' role as spokesperson of the global south.

The enlarged BRICS will have about 45% of the world population, 28% of global GDP and 44% of global crude oil production. Four out of five members are among the world's ten largest countries by population and by area, except for South Africa.

Objectives:

1. The BRICS countries act as one to promote a more democratic international system, including advocating reform of the UN Security Council.
2. The BRICS seeks to deepen, broaden and intensify cooperation within the grouping and among the individual countries for more sustainable, equitable and mutually beneficial development.
3. BRICS takes into consideration each member's growth, development and poverty objectives to ensure relations are built on the respective country's economic strengths and to avoid competition where possible.
4. BRICS is emerging as a new and promising political-diplomatic entity with diverse objectives, far beyond the original objective of reforming global financial institutions.



Evolution of BRICS

The grouping had its first informal meeting during a meeting of the leaders of BRIC (Brazil, Russia, India, and China) countries on the sidelines of the G8 Outreach Summit in St. Petersburg, Russia, in 2006. Later that year, it was formalised during the 1st BRIC Foreign Ministers' Meeting in **New York**.

- **2009:** The **first BRIC** (BRICS minus South Africa) summit was held in **Yekaterinburg, Russia**.
- **2010:** **South Africa** was accepted as a full member, and the group became BRICS.
- **2014:** The **Fortaleza Declaration** was adopted at the 6th BRICS Summit, and it marked the establishment of the New Development Bank (NDB).
- **2022:** The **Beijing Declaration** was adopted at the 14th BRICS Summit, where it was declared that the BRICS countries support talks between **Russia and Ukraine**.

Significance:

1. Expanded BRICS has among the largest energy producers (Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iran) and largest consumers (China and India). It can significantly influence the global energy markets.
2. Inclusion of Egypt and Ethiopia enhances BRICS' geopolitical significance by providing greater influence and access to the crucial maritime trade routes in the Horn of Africa and the Red Sea region.
3. Deeper cooperation among BRICS members, initiative for BRICS currency can lead to rapid dedollarization of global economy.
4. The BRICS countries are trying to position themselves as representatives of the global south, providing an alternative model to G7.
5. Having representation for every continent from global south, the BRICS group is a much stronger platform for South-South cooperation.
6. Expansion of the BRICS is a reflection of a new, multi-polar world order; a result of the shift in economic and political power from the 'Global North' to the 'Global South'.

7. It has created institutions like **New Development Bank** and **Contingency Reserve Arrangement**, that can democratise global financing mechanism.
8. It has become the most powerful voices on geopolitics, global trade and climate change, giving a strong voice to global South.
9. With three of its members neighbouring Afghanistan, it can play a critical role in stabilizing Afghanistan and ensuring that it does not become a cause for instability in the region.
10. BRICS is attempting to pragmatically shape its counter-terrorism strategy by crafting the BRICS Counter Terrorism Action Plan containing specific measures to fight radicalisation, terrorist financing and misuse of the Internet by terrorist groups.
11. In the ongoing **Ukraine crisis**, the grouping holds even more importance because of presence of Russia, China and India who are key stakeholders.

Significance for India:

1. Key to achieving a multipolar world.
2. An example of South-South cooperation for mutual growth and development.
3. BRICS platform provides an opportunity for India to balance Russia-China axis.
4. New Development Bank as a source of financing India's infrastructure projects Including \$1 billion under Covid-19 emergency program.
5. Opportunity to cooperate and set agenda with Russia, China Saudi Arabia, Iran etc. on global issues like climate change, terrorism, technology etc.
6. With presence of key West Asian nations, it can help in deepening cooperation with West Asia.
7. It provides platform for regular engagement with Iran, key to India's access to Central Asia and beyond.
8. Balancing its diplomatic engagements between global east and global West.
9. Can be instrumental in demand for reform of multilateral systems.
10. Participating in the BRICS platform allows India to shape global governance conversations as a rising power and it underscores New Delhi's desire to maintain autonomy in its decision making.

Achievements of BRICS:

1. The successful lobbying for the International Monetary Fund (IMF)'s quota reforms in 2010.
2. BRICS countries have engaged with each other under a common framework on 15 global issues such as agriculture, trade and national security. Collaboration on agriculture and food security was one of the first initiatives by BRICS nations.
3. BRICS members adopted a common position on UN resolutions on intervention in Libya, on issues concerning the Central African Republic, Sudan, and Cote d'Ivoire, but took divergent positions on the resolution against Syria.
4. BRICS has setup **New Development Bank (NDB)** to provide funding in emerging markets & developing countries (EMDCs) and **Contingency Reserve Arrangement (CRA)** to help nations in their balance of payment crisis.
5. In 2021, the BRICS National Development Bank (NDB) membership expanded to include the United Arab Emirates, Bangladesh, Uruguay, and Egypt.

6. Expansion of BRICS reflects its relevance for the nations of global south who yearn for reforms in the institutions of global governance.

Challenges:

1. Economic and geopolitical asymmetry between members.
2. Western sanctions and trade wars limit scope for Economic Cooperation.
3. Increasing heft of China and balancing Chinese interests vis-à-vis interest of other members is becoming more difficult.
4. Each nation is using the organization to expand their own geopolitical interests. This has restricted the scope for cooperation.
5. Intra-BRICS trade remain around 15%. India and South Africa have resisted intra-BRICS FTA as it would polarise BRICS nations between heavily industrialised and lesser industrialised ones.
6. Within BRICS, there is a division. Russia and China have taken a clear anti-West stance, but India, Brazil and South Africa enjoy warm relations with the West. Ukraine crisis has further polarised the organization.
7. New members like Saudi Arabia and Iran have history of conflict and regional rivalry. This might paralyse unanimous decision making at the platform.
8. Big ideas like developing a BRICS credit rating agency and creating a BRICS undersea cable never materialized.
9. A key agenda behind BRICS was reform of global multilateral order. But the agenda has been put on the backburner in recent years. Both China and Russia have not been pro-active about UNSC reform, and China has been creating challenges for India.
10. BRICS came into being because of their shared vision of a new global order where no single state nor any alliance should be allowed to dictate terms in international affairs. But it has changed due to China's rise and its revisionist stance.

Challenges for India:

1. Balancing between BRICS and deepening cooperation with the West.
2. Cooperating with China at the platform while the northern borders remain tense.
3. Lack of trust in cooperating with China on areas like digital economy, innovation etc.
4. China's attempt to shield Pakistan over the issue of terrorism.
5. Maintaining its neutrality over ongoing Ukraine crisis.
6. **Expanding membership:** The concern is the it might tilt the grouping towards China. But it also has some like-minded partners like Saudi Arabia and UAE.
7. Scepticism about tilt of the platform from geoeconomics to geopolitics. With presence of anti-west members like China, Russia and Iran it might transform into an anti-west platform rather than pro-global south.

New Development Bank

1. Came into existence as a result of agreement signed at sixth summit at Fortaleza, Brazil in 2014.
2. All five members have equal initial contribute of \$10 billion each to bring the total capital to \$50 billion.

3. The bank will have starting capital of \$50 billion, with wealth increased to \$100 billion over time.
4. NDB has approved loans worth **\$32.8 billion** for projects ranging from Mumbai metro lines to solar lighting in Brasilia.
5. Recently Bangladesh, United Arab Emirates (UAE), Uruguay and Egypt were added as new members of BRICS New Development Bank (NDB).

Contingency Reserve Arrangement:

The agreement to create CRA was made at the Fortaleza summit. The CRA was established in 2015 during 7th BRICS summit in July 2015. The BRICS CRA proposes to provide short-term liquidity support to the members through currency swaps to help mitigating Balance of Payments crisis situation, in case such a situation arises.

Idea of developing BRICS Currency

1. President Putin in his address to the BRICS business forum said about group developing a new global reserve currency. This will facilitate intra-BRICS trade in local currencies, but also firewall their global financial interests.
2. Brazilian President Lula Da Silva, in the past, had expressed his anguish of dollar domination in Brazilian trade and encouraged the idea of using BRICS as a de-dollarisation coalition.
3. The Indian government considers Russia and China's efforts to reduce dollar usage more ideological than practical and does not explicitly support the mobilisation of BRICS to challenge the dollar's hegemony. Furthermore, the recent military standoffs between India and China further prevent India from supporting China's plans to dethrone the dollar. But India has continuously tried to reduce dependence on dollars.

Future of BRICS:

BRICS nations are also contemplating about launch of a new global currency, backed by Gold. If that happens along with increased membership, it could provide alternative to dollar dominance.

In the longer term, BRICS's future as a forum of constructive dialogue and as a promoter for a multipolar shift in world politics, giving more visibility to Global South's perspective, depends much on Russia's and China's stand on whether they will want to engage and to what extent, or rather push for changes desired by them alone.

G7

An intergovernmental organization formed in 1975 as Group of Six nations to exchange ideas on economic problems of the 1970s — the first oil crisis and the collapse of the system of fixed exchange rates (Bretton Woods). It meets annually to discuss issues such as global economic governance, international security, and energy policy.

The G7 countries are the UK, Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and the US. Russia joined the grouping in 1998, making it G8. Russia's membership was suspended in March 2014 in response to its annexation of Crimea. In 2017, Russia announced to permanently leave G8, making it G7.

Till three decades ago, G7 represented around 70% of global economy. As of 2022, G7 countries make up for 10% of world population, 31% of global GDP and 21% of global carbon dioxide emission.

Jake Sullivan - G7 is the steering committee of the free world.

Key Challenges:

1. It does not have major global economies like China, India and Brazil.
2. It is seen as an attempt by the developed nations to have control over global issues, despite the forum being non-representative.
3. Ukraine crisis has strengthened the grouping after failure of this summit to bring a joint communique in 2019. However, differences among members persist over China and Brexit.
4. Expanded BRICS with greater economic and geopolitical heft has emerged as a major competitor to G7.

In a sign of renewed cooperation, the G7 reached a historic agreement ahead of its 2021 summit to overhaul the global rules for corporate taxation.

The grouping has tried to expand consultation by inviting non-members as participants. India has been invited to the meetings since 2019. In 2022, members invited were India, Argentina, Indonesia, Senegal and South Africa.

G7 summit 2024, Italy

1. Leaders decided to promote **concrete G7 PGII** (Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment) initiatives.
 - PGII was launched by the US and G7 allies at the 48th G 7 Summit in 2022 that aims to narrow the USD 40 trillion infrastructure gap in the developing world.
 - It is a "values-driven, high-impact, and transparent infrastructure partnership to meet the enormous infrastructure needs of low and middle-income countries.
 - Under this, G7 will mobilise \$600 billion by 2027 to deliver infrastructure projects to developing and middle-income countries.
2. G-7 nations committed to promoting the IMEC. The group also extended support for the Lobito Corridor, Luzon Corridor and the Middle Corridor.
 - **Lobito Corridor**: It extends from the port city of Lobito on the Atlantic coast of Angola through the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) and into Zambia.
 - **Luzon Corridor**: It is a strategic economic and infrastructure corridor located on the island of Luzon in the Philippines. Luzon is the largest and most populous island in the Philippines.
 - **Middle Corridor**: It is also referred to as the Trans-Caspian International Transport Route (TITR), a vital logistics and transportation network connecting Europe and Asia.
3. The **Great Green Wall Initiative** to combat desertification and land degradation in the Sahel region of Africa. It aims to create a wall of trees stretching across Africa from west to east to help prevent the spread of the Sahara Desert, improve biodiversity, and provide economic opportunities for local communities.
4. The G7 agreed to provide financing of approximately \$50 billion in additional funding to Ukraine by the end of 2024.

5. The group launch a Semiconductors G7 Point of Contact Group, which is linked to the fears of a Taiwan contingency-induced disruption of the supply chain in the semiconductor trade.

Sanghai Cooperation Organisation

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) is a transcontinental political, economic, and security organisation. In terms of geographic scope and population, it is the world's largest regional organization, covering approx. 60% of the area of Eurasia, 40% of the world population, and more than 30% of global GDP.

SCO comprises of ten member states: **India, Kazakhstan, China, Kyrgyz Republic, Pakistan, Russia, Tajikistan, Iran, Belarus and Uzbekistan**.

The **Heads of State Council (HSC)** is the supreme decision-making body in the SCO. It meets once a year and adopts decisions and guidelines on all important matters of the organisation.

The organisation has two permanent bodies — the SCO Secretariat based in Beijing and the Executive Committee of the Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) based in Tashkent.

Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS):

- Established in 2004 in Tashkent, Uzbekistan as a permanent organ of the SCO
- Promotes cooperation of member states against the three evils of terrorism, separatism and extremism.
- **Maintains working relations** with institutions of the member states and international organisations tackling terrorism, separatism and extremism.
- Assists member states in preparation and conduct of counter-terrorism exercises and other activities to fight terrorism, separatism and extremism.
- **Prepares and holds scientific conferences and workshops**, assistance in sharing experience in the field of fighting terrorism, separatism and extremism.

Main goals of SCO:

1. Strengthening mutual trust and neighbourliness among the member states.
2. Promoting effective cooperation in trade, economy, research, technology and culture, energy, transport, tourism, environmental protection, and other areas.
3. Making joint efforts to maintain and ensure peace, security and stability in the region.
4. Moving towards the establishment of a democratic, fair and rational new international political and economic order.

Significance:

1. Largest regional organisation in terms of population and geography
2. RATS can be critical in counter terrorism cooperation
3. Its emphasis on connectivity can give boost to regional connectivity
4. Can play staler role in stabilising Afghanistan
5. Can be a platform for ensuring stability in the Eurasian region

6. **Green Development Forum** of SCO aims to enhance cooperation among SCO countries in green energy, green industry, climate change mitigation and ecological protection, and to build a stronger consensus on green development.

Importance for India:

1. Makes India part of Eurasian Security architecture
2. Helps India in breaking out of South Asian geography
3. India's membership of the SCO is in line with its current policy of multi-alignment and maintaining its strategic autonomy.
4. Can help in tackling non-Pakistan centric terrorism and extremism challenges
5. Membership of the SCO could be an attempt to increase engagements with the Eurasian region and also intensify its close ties with Russia.
6. Platform for engaging with Pakistan at a time when SAARC remains dysfunctional.
7. SCO can act as a guarantor for projects such as the TAPI (Turkmenistan-Afghanistan-Pakistan-India) to bolster economic ties between Afghanistan, South Asian and Central Asian countries.

Challenges:

1. Mutual distrust among members
2. Most of the members have anti-West stance and the platform is seen as a counter to NATO
3. SCO members prefer to tackle security issues at the bilateral level. Friction and distrust between members prevent the SCO from forming a unified policy on security issues in Afghanistan.
4. It has played limited role in stabilising Afghanistan after USA withdrawal.
5. Platform can get polarised due to Pakistan attempt of settling bilateral scores with India.
6. After Ukraine crisis, the distrust among Central Asian Republics towards Russia has increased. They are looking at new partners.
7. India holding the summit in virtual mode along with PM Modi giving a miss to the Asthana Summit is being seen as India's discomfort with increasingly anti-west stance of the grouping.

Challenges for India:

1. Balancing its partnership with the West, QUAD vis-à-vis SCO membership
2. Membership of Iran and Belarus makes it a more discernible anti-West platform. Increasingly Anti-West stance has made India uncomfortable.
3. Presence of Pakistan makes action against terror More challenging
4. India is the only member which opposes BRI initiative
5. Ongoing border tensions with China has further limited scope for cooperation.
6. China blocking designation of terrorists at the UNSC exposes the limits of counter-terrorism cooperation.
7. Engaging with Central Asia in the face of China-Russia No-Limits Partnership.

India's Presidency of the SCO:

India held the rotating presidency of the SCO for 23rd summit held on 4th July 2023. The theme was **"Towards a SECURE SCO"**. It stands for S: Security, E: Economic development, C: Connectivity, U: Unity, R: Respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity, E: Environmental protection. **Iran** Officially joined as **Ninth member**. It has created **five new pillars and focus areas of cooperation** in SCO. These are Start-ups and Innovation, Traditional Medicine, Digital Inclusion, Youth Empowerment and Shared Buddhist Heritage.

24th SCO Summit, Asthana

- India was represented by EAM S Jaishankar, instead of PM Modi.
- Belarus has become the 10th member state of the SCO.
- SCO Development Strategy: Members of the SCO adopted the SCO Development Strategy until 2035, including resolutions on combating terrorism, separatism, and extremism, anti-drug strategy, energy cooperation, economic development, and cooperation in protected areas and eco-tourism.

G20

The G20 was founded in 1999 after the **Asian financial crisis** as a forum for the Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors to discuss global economic and financial issues. It was upgraded to the level of Heads of State/Government in the wake of the Global Financial Crisis of 2007-08, and in 2009, it was designated the "premier forum for international economic cooperation".

The G20 members represent around 85% of the global GDP, over 75% of the global trade, and about two-thirds of the world population.

G20 Achievements:

1. G20 has shown the spirit of pluralism and contextual relevance by splitting itself into finance and sherpa streams.
2. The Sherpa track, dealing with various developmental issues across the globe, has expanded itself to include issues related to digital economy, environment, education, education etc.
3. The IMF quota reform at the 2010 G20 ministerial summit to double the IMF quota and increase voting rights and shareholding of emerging markets.
4. Establishment of the Financial Stability Board to monitor and makes recommendations about the global financial system.
5. The Debt Service Suspension Initiative in the wake of pandemic to suspended \$12.9 billion in debt-service payments owed by participating countries to their creditors From May 2020 to December 2021.

Highlights of 18th G-20 Summit

- Hosted by India as President. Theme: **'One Earth, One Family, One Future'**
- India has invited nine countries as guest countries. Bangladesh, Egypt, Mauritius, The Netherlands, Nigeria, Oman, Singapore, Spain and the UAE.

Key Outcomes

1. G20 Leaders' New Delhi Declaration achieved unanimous consensus in a world divided on Ukraine crisis. Shows India's diplomatic heft and dexterity.
2. **African Union admitted as a permanent member of G20**- a major step towards increasing the representation of developing countries in the forum.
3. **Global Biofuel Alliance (GBA)** launched with nine initiating members: **India, the US, Brazil, Argentina, Bangladesh, Italy, Mauritius, South Africa, and the United Arab Emirates.**
 - a. An India-led initiative that aims to develop an alliance of governments, international organizations, and industry to promote the adoption of biofuels.
 - b. It seeks to position biofuels as a key component of the energy transition and contribute to job creation and economic growth.
 - c. GBA Members constitute major producers and consumers of biofuels. **USA (52%), Brazil (30%) and India (3%),** contribute about 85% share in production and about 81% in consumption of ethanol.
 - d. As per IEA, there will be 3.5-5x biofuels growth potential by 2050 due to Net Zero targets, creating a huge opportunity.
4. MoU signed between India, US, Saudi Arabia, EU, UAE, France, Germany and Italy to establish the **India Middle East Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC)**. It is part of a broader initiative called the Partnership for Global Infrastructure Investment (PGII).
5. G20 countries promised to work towards tripling the global renewable energy capacity by 2030.
6. The G20 leaders recognize the importance of addressing rising commodity prices, including food and energy prices, which contribute to cost-of-living pressures.
7. G20 leaders called for the full, timely implementation of the Black Sea grain initiative.
8. India's G-20 presidency has laid the foundation for a coordinated and comprehensive policy and regulatory framework for cryptocurrencies.
9. G-20 leaders have recognized the pressing need for more robust and effective Multilateral Development Banks (MDBs) to address the high developmental demands globally.

Harsh Vardhan Shringla, India's G20 chief coordinator, has observed that the presidency gives India an opportunity "to place its priorities and narratives on the global agenda" and also "to showcase India's progress... rich cultural heritage and diversity and tourism potential."

Dr. Jaishankar: India's G20 presidency has served as a catalyst in invigorating the country's foreign policy and also realising the vision of Atmanirbhar and Viksit Bharat.

QUAD

It is an informal strategic dialogue forum between India, USA, Japan and Australia with a shared objective to ensure and support a "free, open and prosperous" Indo-Pacific region.

- Raised to the summit level. Frequent summit meetings underscore the importance attached to the platform.
- Diversified to include vaccine distribution, Climate change and critical and emerging technologies.

- In March 2020, 3 more Indo-Pacific nations New Zealand, South Korea and Vietnam were included in the discussion, which has been touted as QUAD Plus.
- USA changed its Pacific command name to Indo-Pacific Command.
- China has continuously criticised it as “Asian NATO”, tool for containing and besieging China to maintain US hegemony” and to “stoke confrontation and undermine international solidarity and cooperation”

Convergences:

1. Commitment to peace, prosperity, rule-based order and free and open Indo-Pacific.
2. All members agree to the Centrality of ASEAN in their respective Indo-Pacific strategies.
3. Shared concerns about China’s rise and resultant challenges.
4. All members have conflictual relation with China.
5. Common democratic culture, pluralism and Commitment to Rule of Law.

Challenges:

1. Different world views
2. China remains the biggest trade partner of all the 4 nations.
3. Difference in geography with respect to China.
4. Absence of economic and security dimension.
5. India’s strategic autonomy while other three are allies
6. Differing vision about the expanse of Indo-Pacific
7. Emergence of new groupings like AUKUS.
8. Differing position on Ukraine conflict and relation with Russia.

Suggestions:

1. Nations can go for the signing of FTA to deepen economic cooperation.
2. Deepening of security cooperation between India and USA.
3. Need for a free and frank conversation to understand each other’s position
4. Need for USA to accommodate India’s interest.

Indo-Pacific: It has emerged as a new geographical construct comprising of Pacific Ocean and Indian Ocean as a common geopolitical sphere. Its origin can be found in ex-Japanese pm Shinzo Abe’s “Confluence of the Two Seas” speech to the Indian Parliament.

Significance:

1. Region accounts for 60% of global GDP.
2. 60% of maritime trade passes through the waters in the region.
3. The fastest growing emerging economies- ASEAN, India, China are from the region.
4. Geostrategic conflict points like South China Sea, Taiwan etc.
5. US policy of tackling competition from China, reassuring the allies etc.
6. China’s rapid naval expansion

Recent Initiatives:

1. Act East policy that puts greater emphasis on strategic dimension.
2. India has released Maritime Security Strategy 2015 explaining its primary and secondary areas of interest.
3. Agreement with Singapore over logistics support at Changi Naval base.
4. India developing Sabang deep sea port in Indonesia
5. Tri-services command at Andaman and Nicobar Islands, at the mouth of Malacca strait.
6. Rapid expansion of naval capability with Mission-based deployments.
7. Expanding Malabar naval exercise
8. India is a member of QUAD and has forged trilateral cooperation with Japan & Australia and Australia & Indonesia.
9. It has deepened military cooperation with Southeast Asian nations like Philippines and Vietnam.

Challenges for India:

1. Differing geographical boundaries between India and USA
2. Naval capability gap vis-à-vis China
3. India's security posture remains land-oriented and slow movement on theatre commands.
4. China's string of pearls and its investments to acquire strategic assets in the region
5. Increasing Chinese naval presence in the IOR
6. Geopolitical tensions in South Pacific and across Taiwan Strait
7. Chinese island building and militarization of South China Sea.
8. India not a member of RCEP
9. AAGC remains dormant
10. Indian projects facing domestic protests e.g.- Maldives, Mauritius.

AUKUS

AUKUS is a trilateral security pact between Australia, the United Kingdom, and the United States, announced in September 2021 for the Indo-Pacific region. Under the pact, the US and the UK will help Australia to acquire nuclear-powered submarines.

The pact also includes cooperation on "cyber capabilities, artificial intelligence, quantum technologies and additional undersea capabilities".

World Bank

Along with International Monetary Fund (IMF), known as Bretton Woods Twins, it was established at Bretton Woods Conference in 1944. It provides financing, policy advice, and technical assistance to governments of developing countries.

The World Bank Group consists of five development institutions.

1. **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)** provides loans, credits, and grants.
2. **International Development Association (IDA)** provides low- or no-interest loans to low-income countries.

3. **The International Finance Corporation (IFC)** provides investment, advice, and asset management to companies and governments.
4. **The Multilateral Guarantee Agency (MIGA)** insures lenders and investors against political risk such as war.
5. **The International Centre for the Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID)** settles investment-disputes between investors and countries.

The World Bank Group has two goals of ending extreme poverty by 2030 and boosting shared prosperity of the poorest 40% of the population in all countries.

To become a member of the Bank, under the IBRD Articles of Agreement, a country must first join the International Monetary Fund (IMF).

India is not a member of ICSID. India claimed ICSID Convention is not fair, convention's rules for arbitration leaned towards the developed countries.

Achievements:

1. The bank assists poorest developing countries in assisting and financing poverty reduction strategies.
2. The World Bank Group Gender Action Plan was created to advance women's economic empowerment and promote shared growth.
3. At the World Bank's 2012 annual meeting in Tokyo, it developed a new Environmental and Social Framework to ensure that World-Bank financed operations supplement environmental and social safeguards.
4. Together with the World Health Organization, the World Bank administers the International Health Partnership (IHP+) to improving the health of citizens in developing countries.
5. The World Bank doubled its aid for climate change adaptation from \$2.3bn (£1.47bn) in 2011 to \$4.6bn in 2012. In 2017, World Bank announced that it will no longer finance fossil fuel development.
6. During the COVID-19 pandemic, the World Bank announced a \$12 billion plan to supply "low- and middle-income countries" with a vaccine aid and by June 2022, \$10.1 billion had been allocated to supply 78 countries with the vaccine.

Criticism of world Bank Group:

1. World Bank really caters to the agenda of World Capitalism in the garb of its "Structural Adjustment Programme' (SAP) and continues to be dominated by rich countries.
2. It is argued SAP policies have increased the gap between rich and poor in both local and global terms.
3. The emerging new economic powers, particularly India and China, and some other Asian and Latin American countries have not been given due place and role.
4. Failure of World Bank to adapt to the changing world order may see rising economies going their own way. **AIIB** and **NDB** are the examples.

5. The Bank and Fund have also been heavily criticised for the role played by the political expediency of important shareholders in its decision-making and choice of interventions, including its support to dictatorships.

International Monetary Fund

IMF came into operation on 27th December 1945. It has 189 members. It is regarded as the global lender of last resort to national governments, and a leading supporter of exchange-rate stability. Its stated mission is "working to foster global monetary cooperation, secure financial stability, facilitate international trade, promote high employment and sustainable economic growth, and reduce poverty around the world."

Goals of IMF:

1. Fostering global monetary cooperation,
2. Securing financial stability,
3. Facilitating and promoting international trade, employment, and economic growth around the world.

Achievements:

1. IMF loans have helped many countries avoid liquidity crisis, such as Mexico in 1982 and more recently, Greece and Cyprus have received IMF loans.
2. The fact that there is a lender of last resort provides an important confidence boost for investors. This is important during the financial turmoil.

Criticism:

1. These policies reflect the interests and ideology of the Western financial community and neoliberalism.
2. Many-a-times these free-market policies are not suitable for the situation of the country and may lead to social and political unrest.
3. Privatisation can lead to the creation of private monopolies who exploit consumers and exacerbate prevailing inequality.
4. There is also a criticism that bailing out countries with large debt creates moral hazard. Because of the possibility of getting bailed out, it encourages countries to borrow more.
5. The IMF has been criticised for imposing policy with little or no consultation with the affected countries.
6. **Reform Delays:** the approval and implementation of the reforms was held up, mainly because of repeated delays in the U.S. Congress—its ratification is required to meet the 85% voting power approval for constitutional changes by the IMF.
7. **Unequal voting share:** China's voting share, for example is only 6% despite its economy weighing in excess of 10% of global GDP. And India's voting share is still under 3%. Overall, the total share of emerging markets in the IMF remains well below their global share of GDP.

World Trade Organisation

It is an intergovernmental organization that regulates and facilitates international trade between nations. The WTO is the world's largest international economic organization, with 164 member states representing over 96% of global trade and global GDP.

It officially commenced operations on 1 January 1995, pursuant to the 1994 Marrakesh Agreement.

Role of WTO

1. It operates a global system of trade rules.
2. It acts as a forum for negotiating trade agreements
3. It settles trade disputes between its members.
4. It supports the needs of developing countries.

Most-favoured-nation (MFN): Treating other people equally under the WTO agreements, countries cannot normally discriminate between their trading partners. If special favour is granted to some nation, it has to be extended to all other WTO members.

Some exceptions allowed are:

1. Countries can set up a Free Trade Agreement that applies only to goods traded within the group — discriminating against goods from outside.
2. They can give developing countries special access to their markets.
3. A country can raise barriers against products that are considered to be traded unfairly from specific countries.

National Treatment: Treating foreigners and locals equally. Imported and locally-produced goods should be treated equally — at least after the foreign goods have entered the market.

Peace Clause: Temporary provision made at the WTO Bali conference in December 2013. It stipulated that no country would be legally barred from food security programs for its own people even if the subsidy breached the limits specified in the WTO Agreement on Agriculture.

Nairobi Ministerial Conference: Its outcome was Nairobi Package. As per the Nairobi Package:

1. Developed countries had to abolish the farm export subsidies with immediate effect. The developing countries were to eliminate the export subsidies on agricultural exports by 2018 (by 2023 for transport and market related issues). Poorest and food-importing nations were given an additional time frame.
2. Tariffs on 201 IT products were to be eliminated each year with an aim to make IT products duty-free by 2019.

Issues with Nairobi Ministerial:

1. The provisions in the package implied that India would not be able to offer export subsidies for sugar and other farm products after eight years.
2. No final decision was taken on public stock-holding as well as Special Safeguard Mechanisms (SSM).
3. India had demanded that public food procurement be exempted from subsidy reduction deals under WTO norms. But as per the deals, public stockholding must not be more than ten per cent of the value of the total production of food grains.

4. A major setback for India and other developing countries and Least Developed Countries was that the Nairobi talks did not reaffirm the Doha Development Agenda, which was one of India's key demands.

Key Outcomes of the 12th Ministerial Conference (June 2022):

1. **WTO Reform:** Members committed to work towards having a well-functioning dispute settlement system accessible to all members by 2024.
2. **Agreement on Curtailing Harmful Fishing Subsidies:** It would curb 'harmful' subsidies on illegal, unreported and unregulated (IUU) fishing for the next four years, to better protect global fish stocks.
3. **Agreement on Global Food Security:** Members agreed to a binding decision to exempt food purchased by the UN's World Food Programme (WFP) for humanitarian purposes, from any export restrictions. However, countries would be allowed to restrict food supplies to ensure domestic food security needs.
4. **Agreement on E-commerce Transactions:** Members agreed to continue the long-standing moratorium on custom duties on e-commerce transmissions until the next Ministerial Conference or until 31st March 2024, whichever comes first.
5. **Agreement on 'Covid-19' Vaccine Production:** WTO members agreed to temporarily waive intellectual property patents on Covid-19 vaccines without the consent of the patent holder for 5 years, so that they can more easily manufacture them domestically.

Key Outcomes of the 13th Ministerial Conference (Feb-March 2022):

1. Ministers endorsed the accession of two least-developed countries—Comoros and Timor-Leste to the WTO. This brings the organisation's Membership to 166, representing 98% of world trade.
2. Ministers renewed their commitment to achieve a fully functional dispute settlement system accessible to all Members by 2024.
3. Ministers decided to renew the e-commerce moratorium until MC14 or 31 March 2026, whichever is earlier.
4. Ministers decided to extend a moratorium on so-called "non-violation" and "situation" complaints under the TRIPS Agreement, mainly linked to e-commerce. Otherwise, it permitted members to challenge at dispute settlement forum.

Achievements of WTO:

1. The real volume of world trade has expanded by 2.7 times since the inception of WTO.
2. After the creation of WTO, average tariffs have almost halved from 10.5% to 6.4%. This has facilitated the growth of international trade.
3. Accession to WTO has given a lasting boost to national income of several developing economies.
4. The predictable market conditions fostered by the WTO have combined with improved communications to enable the rise of global value chains. Trade within these global value chains today accounts for almost 70% of total merchandise trade.

5. Taking into account, the World Bank's \$1.90 threshold for extreme poverty, the poverty level has fallen from ~33.33% in 1995 to ~10% today.

Criticism of WTO:

1. It only serves the interests of multinational corporations, undermines local governments penalises poor countries and is increasing inequality.
2. Some agreements about agriculture and pharmaceutical goods have led to restricted access to food and healthcare.
3. Policies like Most Favoured Nation and National Treatment failed to protect developing nations and even take advantage of their infantile industries. As per UNCTAD estimates, market distortions have cost developing countries \$ 700 billion annually in export revenue.
4. Nations do not negotiate as equals, rather there is green room diplomacy among key influential members of the WTO.
5. Lack of commitment to Doha Development Agenda underscores the neglect of concerns of developing nations.
6. Emergence of plurilateral and regional trade groupings like RCEP & CPTPP Undermine the importance of WTO.
7. The MC13 also failed to make progress on key issues like fisheries subsidies, reflecting serious divisions among 166 member countries.

United Nations

The United Nations is an intergovernmental organization whose purpose is to maintain international peace and security, develop friendly relations among nations, achieve international cooperation, and be a centre for harmonizing the actions of nations.

The United States hosted the San Francisco Conference in early 1945 to finalise and sign the Charter of the 'United Nations'. Initially it had 51 countries as member nations which has currently increased to 192.

Purposes and Principles:

The Charter indicates four broad objectives of the United Nations:

1. To maintain international peace and security through collective measures for suppression of aggression and through peaceful settlement of disputes.
2. To develop friendly relations among countries based on full respect for the principle of equality and self-determination.
3. To achieve international cooperation in the economic, social, cultural or humanitarian fields.
4. To encourage respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.

Principal Organs: Composition and Functions:

The General Assembly: The principles of sovereign equality and universality are embodied in its composition. All members of the United Nations are members of the General Assembly. Irrespective of size or strength, every member has one vote in the Assembly.

Functions:

- The Assembly discusses problems brought to it, makes recommendations on peace and security questions, admits new members, and adopts UN budget.
- On important matters, it adopts resolutions with the support of two-third majority. Procedural decisions require only a simple majority.
- The Assembly elects members of various organs. It also appoints the Secretary General.
- It supervises the work of the Economic and Social Council, the Security Council, the Trusteeship Council and other bodies.
- The Assembly has the power to approve the budget of the United Nations and to apportion the amount among all the member countries.

Challenges: Despite being the most representative organization, its power is limited to giving recommendations. Its decisions can be vetoed by the UNSC.

The Security Council: The Security Council is the most powerful decision-making body of the United Nations. Unlike the Assembly, the membership of the Council is limited to 15 countries only, out of which five are permanent members. These five countries are **China, France, Russia, the UK and the USA**. The remaining ten members- called non-permanent members are elected by the General Assembly for a term of two years. On substantive questions, the nine affirmative votes should include concurring vote of the permanent members.

Functions:

- It has the main responsibility to maintain international peace and security.
- In case, a dispute arises between two or more countries the Council can make appropriate recommendations in the interest of peaceful settlement of the dispute. Nevertheless, these recommendations are not binding on the unwilling states.
- The Council can use extraordinary power to deal with wars or threats of war between countries. In such an event, the Council can determine who the aggressor is and can call for necessary steps to restore peace.
- These steps may include economic sanctions like freezing of assets abroad, banning of exports and imports, or military action by land, sea or air.
- Notably, whenever the Security Council takes such steps, they are binding not only on the states directly involved in the war but also on all members of the United Nations.
- Once the Security Council takes a decision, it is the duty of the member countries to carry out decisions.

Challenges: It has become arena of great power politics. Decisions are not taken in the interest of global community, but as per geopolitical consideration of veto wielding members. It has remained polarised since the Cold War. It is also non representative. While West is overrepresented, developing world is under represented with no representation from Africa or Latin America.

Proposals for UNSC Reforms:

2005 Annan plan:

- **Plan A** calls for creating six new permanent members, plus three new non-permanent members for a total of 24 seats in the council.
- **Plan B** calls for creating eight new seats in a new class of members, who would serve for four years, subject to renewal, plus one non-permanent seat, also for a total of 24.

The Economic and Social Council: The Economic and Social Council works to promote international cooperation in economic and social fields. It comprises 54 members all of whom are elected for a term of three years by the General Assembly, giving representation to various geographical regions. Decisions are taken by a simple majority of members present and voting. It considers international economic, social, cultural and humanitarian problems. The Council has set up commissions to study and advise on the status of women, population, human rights, etc.

Challenges: Absence of an effective machinery to implement various programmes. Over the years, its functional area has considerably increased, but its effectiveness has always been in doubt.

Trusteeship Council: The Trusteeship Council was created to supervise the working of the international trusteeship system. All the 11 territories, originally placed under the trusteeship system have become free. Now that there is no trust territory to be administered, the Trusteeship Council has ceased to play an active role in the UN system and does not hold meetings. The Charter has to be amended to dissolve this organ.

International Court of Justice: The International Court of Justice, known as the World Court, located at The Hague (The Netherlands), is the principal judicial organ of the United Nations. The Court consists of 15 judges, who are elected jointly by the General Assembly and the Security Council for a term of nine years. Only member nations, not private individuals, can bring cases before the Court. And the judgements are not binding.

Functions:

- To settle legal disputes submitted by States, in accordance with international law.
- To give advisory opinions on legal questions referred to it by authorized UN organs and specialized agencies.

Criticism:

- It has no jurisdiction over individuals who are accused of crimes against humanity and war crimes. It cannot have a prosecutor to initiate proceedings.
- It does not have suo moto provisions and hence, **cannot take up cases on will** and has to be requested to do so by the States.
- The ICJ's jurisdiction is consensual and cannot be exercised on countries that don't accept it.
- The Security Council's permanent members can always veto the verdicts as per their geopolitical interests.

Secretariat: The UN Secretariat comprises the international staff posted at the UN headquarters, New York and other locations throughout the world. They are expected to be impartial and independent in

the discharge of their responsibilities. The Chief of the Secretariat is the Secretary General who is appointed by the General Assembly on the recommendation of the Security Council for a term of five years.

Functions:

- To help carry out the decisions made by the different organs of the United Nations.
- To organize international conferences.
- To translate speeches and distribute documents into the UN's official languages.
- To keep the public informed about the work of the United Nations

Criticism: It has been criticised as a bunch of inefficient bureaucrats. It also lacks representation from LDCs.

Achievements of UN:

1. UNSG U Thant was prime negotiator during Cuban missile crisis.
2. It has been platform for dialogue between major powers to avoid conflicts.
3. UNGA provides opportunity for smaller and developing nations to come together and project their viewpoint. Treaty on prohibition of nuclear weapons is an example.
4. Its specific institutions like FAO, ILO, WHO etc. Have played stellar roll in in areas like food security, protection of labour rights, tackling diseases and pandemics, capacity building of poorer nations etc.
5. UN peacekeeping operations have helped in tackling conflicts, mainly in Africa.

Failures of UN:

1. Inability to prevent genocide by Pakistan in 1971, Srebrenica massacre, ethnic cleansing in Sudan etc.
2. Inability to settle Arab-Israeli conflict.
3. In the ongoing conflicts in Ukraine and Gaza, UN has not been able to do anything to ensure peace.
4. Lacks equitable representativeness of various regions of the globe.
5. Nations going for military action against UN mandate. E.g.- Military intervention in Iraq, NATO bombing of Yugoslavia, Ongoing Ukraine crisis etc.
6. Lack of reforms as per the needs of 21st century.
7. Many times, UN has been outperformed by NGOs.
8. It has to remain dependent on different nations and donations for funds.

United Nations Peace Keeping Force

The United Nations Peacekeepers ensure that peace agreements/accords are implemented in warzones. In addition, they give help through confidence-building measures, electoral support, improving law and order and bolstering social development that will bring positive economic changes. UN Peacekeeping is guided by **three basic principles**: 1. Consent of the parties 2. Impartiality 3. Non-use of force except in self-defence and defence of the mandate.

- The United Nations Charter authorises the United Nations Security Council to take collective action to maintain international peace and security. Due to this, it falls on the UN Security Council to deploy peacekeepers in order to ensure stability and security in conflict regions.

- Since its inception in 1948, UN peacekeeping forces have played key role in ending conflicts and maintaining peace in places like **Cambodia, El Salvador, Mozambique, and Namibia.**

Criticism of UN Peacekeeping Operations:

- There have been several reports of human rights abuse by UN soldiers, notably in Central African Republic in 2015.
- Significant cost of these missions has resulted in lacking public support for these missions.
- Lack of consultation with troop-contributing nations in deployment of forces has emerged as another challenge.
- The decision for deployment is not objective but based on geopolitical interests of P-5 members.
- Nations have also been criticised for providing poorly trained and ill-equipped personnel.
- Increasing cases of civil wars have made the peacekeeping operations more challenging. Many-a-times, there is threat on the lives of peacekeepers. Thus, there is demand for robust peacekeeping.
- Often missions require approval from local governments before deploying troops which also **limits the effectiveness of UN missions.**

India's Contributions:

- India is one of the largest contributors of troops to UNPKOs. More than 200,000 Indian troops have served in 49 of the 71 UNPKOs deployed so far. 179 soldiers have lost their lives in the line of duty.
- The Indian Army has established the **Centre for United Nations Peacekeeping (CUNPK)** in New Delhi to provide training for more than 12,000 troops every year.
- In 2007, India became the first country to deploy an all-women contingent to a UN Peacekeeping Mission.

Commemorating 75th International Day of United Nations Peace keepers on 29th May 2023, India unveiled plans to train women personnel from South East Asia, as part of their collaboration with ASEAN in the defence sector.

World Health Organisation

World Health Organization is United Nations' specialized agency for Health was founded in 1948. It is headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland. It has 194 Member States, six regional offices and 150 country offices. **World Health Assembly (WHA)** is the highest decision-making body. The Executive Board gives effect to the decisions and policies of the Assembly. The Organization is headed by the Director-General, who is appointed by the Health Assembly on the nomination of the Executive Board.

Objectives:

- To act as the directing and coordinating authority on international health work.
- To establish and maintain effective collaboration with the United Nations, specialized agencies, governmental health administrations, professional groups and such other organizations as may be deemed appropriate.
- To provide assistance to the Governments, upon request, in strengthening health services.

- To promote cooperation among scientific and professional groups which contribute to the advancement of health.

Achievements:

- Eradication of smallpox in 1980
- Reduction in the number of deaths from malaria and tuberculosis
- Development of vaccines and treatments for HIV/AIDS, polio, and other diseases
- Provision of technical assistance to countries to improve their health systems
- Coordination of the global response to health emergencies like SARS, Ebola, Covid-19 etc.

Challenges:

- WHO doesn't have own source of fund and has to depend on member states and donor organisations for contributions.
- WHO does not have the authority to enforce its recommendations. It can only provide guidelines, but has to depend on respective member states for implementation, who differ in capacity.
- Political interference and lack of coordination by members impacts its efficacy and functioning.
- In incidences like spread of **Ebola in Africa**, WHO has been criticised for not reacting swiftly enough.
- WHO has no authority to take action in a member state unless that member state asks for help. This hinders action against pandemics as seen in case of Covid-19.
- The **Global Malaria Eradication Programme**, launched in 1955, did not succeed. Ultimately it was discontinued in 1969.
- During Covid-19 pandemic, the organisation has been criticised for delays and going soft on China.